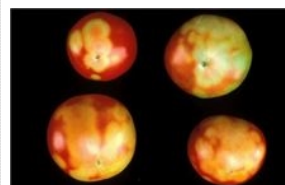


Tomato spotted wilt virus on tomato - Ghana

Tomato spotted wilt virus Spotted wilt disease



Symptoms of tomato spotted wilt caused by Tomato spotted wilt virus. (Source: Dr. Michael Melzer, Flickr)



Symptoms of tomato spotted wilt caused by Tomato spotted wilt virus in Hawaii. (Source: John Hu, Flickr)



Ring spots on red fruit (left), and distortion on green fruit (right). (Source: William M. Brown Jr., Bugwood.org)

Prevention	Monitoring	Direct Control	Direct Control	Restrictions
- Thoroughly inspect any imported planting material and accept only virus and thrips-free seedlings for planting (the virus is not seed-borne). - Remove and destroy old tomato plants and other host crops after harvest. - Aubergine, capsicum, cucurbits, vicia bean, lettuce, potato and tobacco are common crop hosts of the virus and vector. Control weeds and volunteer plants in fallow fields. - Control the population of thrips. - Select resistant varieties of tomato. - Avoid planting near crops affected with the virus. - Control weeds in and around fields.	- Monitor seedlings and plants in the field for thrips and for symptoms of TSWV. - Use blue sticky traps to monitor the population of thrips (whitefly and aphids do not transmit this virus). If thrips are seen early in the season, control may be required. - Look out for symptoms such as ring spots, especially on fruit, chlorotic blotches, mottling and line patterns on leaves. Distortion on leaves and rings on fruits. - Look out for dark spots and ring patterns on fruits purpling and wilting on the leaves. Wilting is not a common symptom despite the name of the virus.	- Rogue out seedlings (in the nursery) and infected plants (in the field) and burn them. - Use reflective mulches to repel the thrips. - Remove and destroy infected plants in the field.	- Wear appropriate PPE and observe the post-harvest intervals. - Apply imidacloprid at 10-15 ml/15 l at 7-14 day intervals at the early vegetative stage, depending on the pest population. - To control vector spray thiamethoxam at 30 g/15 l for 2 consecutive times at 14 days intervals during the active vegetative stages to control the vector. - Thrips pupate in the soil beneath the crop and insecticide run off may not be wasted as it will be active in the soil.	- FRAC: 3A. WHO Class II (moderately hazardous). REI: 24 hrs; PHI: 24 days. Thrips become resistant to insecticides rapidly; make sure you change insecticide regularly. - WHO Class II (moderately hazardous); PHI: 28 days. Thrips become resistant to insecticides rapidly; make sure you change insecticide regularly.

Ghana

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AUTHOR(S): Grace Vanderpujje (University of Cape Coast), Emmanuella Lekete (Oil Palm Research Institute-CSIR), Patrick Besheh, Awudu Gariba (PPRSD), Joseph Honger (University of Ghana), Andrew Sarkordie (BNARI-GAEC), Walter Hevi (CABI)

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